

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 9)

Page 42 - Literature of the Early Renaissance in England

Q1. Which classical work heavily influenced the description of an ideal state in More's Utopia?

- A. Aristotle's Poetics
- B. Plato's Republic
- C. Homer's Odyssey
- D. Ovid's Metamorphoses

Answer: B

Q2. In what year did Ralph Robinson translate More's Utopia into English?

- A. 1516
- B. 1525
- C. 1551
- D. 1568

Answer: C

Q3. Who is considered one of the earliest masters of original English prose, writing Toxophilus?

- A. Sir Thomas More
- B. Roger Ascham
- C. William Tyndale
- D. Miles Coverdale

Answer: B

Q4. What is the subject of Ascham's Toxophilus?

- A. A utopian society
- B. The Schole of Shooting
- C. A religious argument
- D. The history of the printing press

Answer: B

Q5. Which poet evolved a coarse, vigorous style for satiric attacks on Cardinal Wolsey?

- A. Stephen Hawes
- B. John Skelton

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C. Sir Thomas Wyatt

D. Henry Howard

Answer: B

Q6. At whose thoroughly Italianised court did the new movement in poetry really begin?

A. Henry VII

B. Henry VIII

C. Edward VI

D. Queen Mary

Answer: B

Q7. Which two poets are conspicuously associated with the new movement in poetry?

A. Chaucer and Gower

B. Lydgate and Hoccleve

C. Sir Thomas Wyatt and Henry Howard, Earl of Surrey

D. Ascham and More

Answer: C

Q8. What specific poetic form did Wyatt and Surrey bring from Italy?

A. The Ballad

B. The Sonnet

C. The Limerick

D. The Epic

Answer: B

Q9. Surrey was the first English poet to use which verse form (in his translation of the Aeneid)?

A. Blank verse

B. Rhyme royal

C. Free verse

D. Heroic couplet

Answer: A

Q10. In what famous collection (published in 1557) are Wyatt and Surrey the chief poets represented?

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- A. The Canterbury Tales
- B. Lyrical Ballads
- C. Tottel's Miscellany
- D. The Book of the Duchess

Answer: C

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Page 43 - Table of English Literature (1400-1557)

Q1. What topic does the author state has been omitted so far and will be covered in the next chapter?

- A. The development of the novel
- B. The development of the drama
- C. The history of scientific writing
- D. The evolution of English dictionaries

Answer: B

Q2. According to the table, when did Henry IV die?

- A. 1413
- B. 1422
- C. 1450
- D. 1485

Answer: A

Q3. In what year was Lydgate's 'Falles of Princes' written?

- A. 1412
- B. 1422
- C. 1430
- D. 1449

Answer: C

Q4. When did the Wars of the Roses occur according to the table?

- A. 1413-1422
- B. 1430-1449
- C. 1455-1486
- D. 1485-1509

Answer: C

Q5. When was Caxton's printing press set up?

- A. 1450
- B. 1476

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C. 1485

D. 1500

Answer: B

Q6. When was the Battle of Bosworth fought?

A. 1455

B. 1470

C. 1485

D. 1509

Answer: C

Q7. What are the dates of Henry VIII's reign?

A. 1485-1509

B. 1509-1547

C. 1547-1553

D. 1553-1558

Answer: B

Q8. When did Tyndale publish his New Testament?

A. 1516

B. 1525

C. 1535

D. 1551

Answer: B

Q9. Who reigned from 1547-1553?

A. Henry VII

B. Henry VIII

C. Edward VI

D. Mary

Answer: C

Q10. What is the final entry on the timeline for this period (1557)?

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- A. Tottel's Miscellany
- B. More's Utopia
- C. Coverdale's Bible
- D. The birth of Shakespeare

Answer: A

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Page 44 - Table of English Literature (Conclusion)

Q1. During what years did Queen Mary reign?

- A. 1509-1547
- B. 1547-1553
- C. 1553-1558
- D. 1558-1603

Answer: C

Q2. The word Utopia is formed from two Greek words meaning what?

- A. Good place
- B. Nowhere
- C. Perfect city
- D. Heaven on earth

Answer: B

Q3. How has the adjective 'Utopian' been integrated into modern use?

- A. It is only used in scientific textbooks
- B. It has passed into our common speech
- C. It is exclusively a legal term
- D. It was banned by the church

Answer: B

Q4. Which of the following is true based on the footnote regarding Utopia?

- A. Utopia literally translates to 'everywhere'
- B. Sir Thomas More invented the Greek language
- C. The name Utopia means 'Nowhere'
- D. The word has no modern English equivalent

Answer: C

Q5. Which monarch immediately preceded Queen Mary?

- A. Henry VII
- B. Henry VIII

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C. Edward VI

D. Elizabeth I

Answer: C

Q6. Which famous literary collection was published during Mary's reign?

A. Lyrical Ballads

B. The Faerie Queene

C. Tottel's Miscellany

D. First Folio

Answer: C

Q7. Based on the previous timeline context, Queen Mary's reign occurred right before which major English era?

A. The Norman Conquest

B. The Elizabethan Era

C. The Victorian Era

D. The Restoration

Answer: B

Q8. According to the footnote, what language are the roots of the word 'Utopia' derived from?

A. Latin

B. French

C. Greek

D. Celtic

Answer: C

Q9. What literary trend is highlighted by the creation of words like 'Utopia' passing into common speech?

A. The decline of classical education

B. The impact of the Renaissance and classical learning on English

C. The total replacement of English with Greek

D. The isolation of English scholars

Answer: B

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Q10. What year marked the end of Queen Mary's reign?

A. 1547

B. 1553

C. 1557

D. 1558

Answer: D

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Page 45 - Development of Drama to 1561 (Part 1)

Q1. The earliest mention of dramatic representation in England refers to a play in honor of whom?

- A. St. George
- B. St. Katherine
- C. King Arthur
- D. The Virgin Mary

Answer: B

Q2. Around what year did this earliest recorded performance at Dunstable take place?

- A. 1066
- B. 1110
- C. 1215
- D. 1340

Answer: B

Q3. From what had the early religious drama evolved?

- A. Greek tragedies
- B. Roman comedies
- C. The rich symbolic liturgy of the Church
- D. Peasant folk dances

Answer: C

Q4. What was the direct purpose of these early religious dramas?

- A. Pure entertainment for the king
- B. To make money for the church
- C. Didactic; to instruct the unlettered masses in the truths of their religion
- D. To train professional actors

Answer: C

Q5. In the beginning, who were the actors in these religious plays?

- A. Professional actors from France
- B. The priests

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C. The local townspeople

D. The royal family

Answer: B

Q6. What language was initially employed in these church performances?

A. Old English

B. Norman French

C. The Latin of the service

D. Middle English

Answer: C

Q7. What was this early form of religious drama called?

A. The morality play

B. The mystery or miracle play

C. The interlude

D. The tragedy

Answer: B

Q8. As the plays became more popular, where were they moved to from the interior of the church?

A. The king's palace

B. The porch, then the churchyard, and finally the village green/street

C. Specially built amphitheaters

D. Underground crypts

Answer: B

Q9. When laymen began to take part, what language eventually substituted the original Latin?

A. Only English

B. Only French

C. First French, then English

D. Italian

Answer: C

Q10. What does the transition from church interior to village street indicate about the plays?

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- A. They were banned by the Pope
- B. They became increasingly secularized and public
- C. They were no longer about religion
- D. The churches were all destroyed

Answer: B

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Page 46 - Development of Drama to 1561 (Part 2)

Q1. In what century did the religious drama in England reach its height?

- A. The 12th century
- B. The 13th century
- C. The 14th century
- D. The 16th century

Answer: C

Q2. During which festival in early summer were these plays typically represented?

- A. Christmas
- B. Easter
- C. Corpus Christi
- D. All Saints' Day

Answer: C

Q3. How were the Corpus Christi plays arranged?

- A. As single, short, unconnected skits
- B. In great connected sequences or cycles exhibiting the history of man's fall and redemption
- C. As lengthy philosophical debates
- D. As purely musical performances

Answer: B

Q4. Who took charge of the performance of these collective mysteries in the towns?

- A. The King's guards
- B. The local monasteries
- C. The Trading Guilds
- D. Professional acting troupes

Answer: C

Q5. Which of the following is NOT one of the four complete cycles that have come down to us?

- A. The Chester cycle
- B. The Coventry cycle

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C. The Wakefield cycle

D. The London cycle

Answer: D

Q6. How does each of the complete cycles begin and end?

A. Begins with the Nativity, ends with the Ascension

B. Begins with the Creation, ends with the Last Judgment

C. Begins with the Exodus, ends with the Crucifixion

D. Begins with Noah's Flood, ends with the Resurrection

Answer: B

Q7. Which scene is mentioned as touching the note of pathos in these plays?

A. The Last Judgment

B. The Flood

C. The story of Abraham and Isaac

D. The Creation

Answer: C

Q8. The Shepherd plays of the Wakefield series are noted for introducing what element?

A. Intense tragedy

B. Historical accuracy

C. A comic element (rough country farces)

D. Complex theological arguments

Answer: C

Q9. Which famous playwright likely witnessed the miracle plays given annually at Coventry during his boyhood?

A. Geoffrey Chaucer

B. William Shakespeare

C. Christopher Marlowe

D. Ben Jonson

Answer: B

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Q10. How did morality plays differ from miracle plays?

- A. They were not didactic
- B. They were performed exclusively in Latin
- C. Their characters were personified abstractions rather than figures from sacred narrative
- D. They were only performed by priests

Answer: C